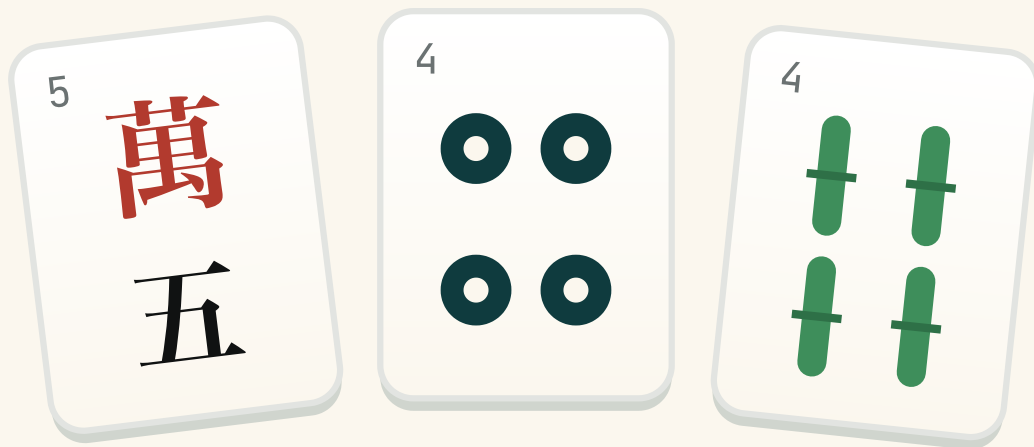


The Mahjong **Night** Kit

Two printable sheets from the full kit: the run-of-show timeline for a three-hour night, and the tile-families reference your table will actually use.





Print this page and keep it near you — it's the one document that carries the actual evening. Times are guides, not gospel; the point is the *order* and the *proportions*, not hitting each mark to the minute.

THE MAHJONG NIGHT — RUN OF SHOW

0:00 – 0:20 • Arrival Drinks and snacks out before anyone sits at a table. Let people settle in as themselves before you turn them into mahjong players. Don't seat anyone yet.

0:20 – 0:40 • Teach Gather everyone around one table. Run the 20-minute crash course from **Teaching the Game** — goal, tiles, the draw-discard loop, the three sets, winning. Say out loud that scoring is coming later, not now.

0:40 – 1:10 • First hands (practice, no scoring) Split into tables of four. Play several full hands with no faan, no scorekeeping — just building the shape and calling wins. This is the block that actually teaches the game; treat it as non-negotiable, not something to rush through if you're behind schedule.

1:10 – 1:20 • Break Refill drinks, reset snacks, let people stretch. Good moment to shuffle who's sitting where if a table wants to mix up their four.

1:20 – 2:40 • Real rounds Scoring on. Hand out the **Cheat Sheet**'s faan reference to each table now — this is the first time it matters. This is the longest block of the night on purpose; it's where the actual game happens.

2:40 – 3:00 • Wind-down Call last hand at each table. Food back out. Let people linger at the table instead of clearing it immediately — some of the best conversation of the night happens over a half-finished hand nobody's in a hurry to put away.

Host notes: - If you're running a 5–7 person rotation (see **Before the Night**), announce the swap system during the Teach block, not during play. - If a table finishes a hand early and is waiting on others, that's fine — let them start another rather than sit idle. - The 30-minute practice block is the one thing not to cut, even if you're running behind. Everything downstream depends on it.



Cheat Sheets — Starter

Print this section and leave one copy per table. This is the reference your guests will actually glance at mid-game — keep it visible, not tucked in a binder.

Tile Families

FAMILY	WHAT'S IN IT
Characters	Numbered 1–9, one suit
Bamboos	Numbered 1–9, one suit (the 1 Bamboo is traditionally drawn as a bird, not a bamboo stalk — a nod to the sparrow the game is named for)
Circles (also called Dots)	Numbered 1–9, one suit
Winds	East, South, West, North — honor tiles, no suit
Dragons	Red, Green, White — honor tiles, no suit
Flowers	Bonus tiles. Draw one, set it aside face-up, draw a replacement immediately. Flowers never count toward your hand's four-sets-and-a-pair — they're pure bonus.

A full set runs 136 tiles for play, plus 8 bonus Flower and Season tiles (144 total) — worth a quick count if a hand ever feels short.

Turn Order

Play moves **counter-clockwise** around the table. Draw, then discard, then it's the next player's turn.

THE FULL KIT

Six more sections, ready to print.

The complete Mahjong Night Kit adds the guest-count and invite playbook, table setup, the 20-minute beginner teach (with the scoring-deferral trick), the full claiming and faan cheat sheets, one-handed food planning, and a troubleshooting section for every way the night can wobble.

mahjmahj.co/guides/mahjong-night